

Day 62 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in History & Archaeology (2): 2025 Discoveries

READING MATERIAL

Covers major 2025 Indian archaeological discoveries, with particular attention to the Tamil Nadu iron-objects find — directly extending the already-shipped Day-48 topic on Arikamedu/Keezhadi with a newer, equally significant discovery.

Q: What significant archaeological discovery was made in Tamil Nadu in February 2025?

A: Iron objects were discovered at SIX sites across Tamil Nadu, all believed to be between 5,000 and 5,400 years old — a highly significant finding for understanding the early use of iron technology in the region.

Q: What first-of-its-kind Harappan discovery was made in 2025, and where?

A: Harappan civilization remains (pottery, bangles, bricks, a furnace, ancient wall remains) were found in the Thar Desert, near Jaisalmer (close to the Pakistan border) — the FIRST time artifacts from the 4,500-year-old Harappan civilization have been found in the Thar Desert specifically.

Q: What megalithic discovery did the ASI make in Kerala in March 2025?

A: Over 110 megaliths spread across 45 hectares of land in Palakkad, Kerala — expected to shed light on the early Iron Age society in Kerala.

Q: What is significant about the ancient structure discovered in Solapur district, Maharashtra?

A: Archaeologists uncovered India's LARGEST known ancient circular labyrinth, in the Boramani grasslands — approximately 50 by 50 feet, made of 15 concentric stone circles, dated to nearly 2,000 years ago and linked to the Satavahana dynasty.

Q: What recent expansion has the ASI made to its archaeological research capabilities?

A: The ASI expanded its Underwater Archaeology Wing in 2025, focusing on exploring coastal waters in Maharashtra, Gujarat, and Tamil Nadu to locate submerged historical sites.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Iron objects discovered at six sites in Tamil Nadu (February 2025) were dated to approximately how many years old?

- A. 1,000-1,500
- B. 2,500-3,000
- C. 5,000-5,400 ✓**
- D. 8,000-9,000

Explanation: 5,000-5,400 years old. [medium, web-research]

2. In 2025, Harappan civilization remains were found for the first time in which desert region?

- A. Thar Desert ✓**
- B. Rann of Kutch
- C. Lahaul Desert
- D. Rajasthan's Shekhawati region

Explanation: Thar Desert. [medium, web-research]

3. In March 2025, the ASI discovered over 110 megaliths across 45 hectares in which state?

- A. Tamil Nadu
- B. Karnataka
- C. Kerala ✓**
- D. Andhra Pradesh

Explanation: Kerala (Palakkad). [medium, web-research]

4. India's largest known ancient circular labyrinth, discovered in Solapur district, Maharashtra, is linked to which dynasty?

- A. Chola
- B. Satavahana ✓**
- C. Maurya
- D. Gupta

Explanation: Satavahana dynasty. [hard, web-research]

5. The ASI's Underwater Archaeology Wing, expanded in 2025, focuses on coastal waters in Maharashtra, Gujarat, and which other state?

A. Odisha

B. Tamil Nadu ✓

C. Goa

D. Kerala

Explanation: Tamil Nadu. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Visual Reasoning

READING MATERIAL

Visual Reasoning is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills, testing image-based logic rather than text/number puzzles — mirror images, water images, and embedded figures are the standard formats. Note: TNPSC's own answer key has at least one acknowledged disputed mirror-image question, a useful reminder that on visual questions specifically, double-check your own reasoning rather than assuming the 'obvious' answer is automatically right.

Q: What is the rule for a MIRROR image, and what stays the same vs. flips?

A: A mirror image flips LEFT and RIGHT (the right side of the object appears on the left, and vice versa), while TOP and BOTTOM stay the same. Imagine holding the figure up to a vertical mirror.

Q: What is the rule for a WATER image, and how is it different from a mirror image?

A: A water image flips TOP and BOTTOM (it appears upside-down, as if reflected in still water below the object), while LEFT and RIGHT stay the same. This is the opposite axis of flipping compared to a mirror image.

Q: What is the best strategy for solving mirror/water image questions quickly?

A: Focus on the most unique or asymmetric part of the figure first (not the symmetric parts, which look the same either way) — mentally flip just that distinctive part along the correct axis (vertical line for mirror, horizontal line for water), and use it to eliminate options before checking the rest.

Q: What is an 'embedded figure' question, and what does it test?

A: A question where a simple shape is hidden within a more complex, cluttered figure, and you must identify which of the answer-choice shapes appears embedded within it. Tests visual scanning and pattern-matching rather than flipping/rotation.

Q: Real exam (flagged as disputed by TNPSC itself): A figure is shown, and you must choose its correct mirror image from 4 options.

What's the most reliable way to verify your choice, given that even the official answer key has had disputed cases here?

A: Don't just eyeball it — explicitly trace which side each distinctive feature should land on after a left-right flip, point by point, rather than relying on a quick visual impression. Given that TNPSC's own committee has had to review at least one mirror-image answer, treat your worked-through reasoning as more trustworthy than a snap visual judgment, and double-check rather than rushing.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. In a MIRROR image of a figure, which pair of sides swap?

- A. Top and bottom
- B. Left and right ✓**
- C. Diagonal corners only
- D. Nothing swaps

Explanation: Left and right swap; top and bottom stay the same. [easy, web-research]

2. In a WATER image of a figure, which pair of sides swap?

- A. Top and bottom ✓**
- B. Left and right
- C. Both pairs swap
- D. Neither swaps

Explanation: Top and bottom swap; left and right stay the same. [easy, web-research]

3. The letter 'b' would appear as which letter in its mirror image (left-right flip)?

- A. b
- B. d ✓**
- C. p
- D. q

Explanation: 'b' has its stem on the left with the bowl attached at bottom-right. Flipping left-right moves the stem to the right with the bowl at bottom-left — that's the letter 'd'. [medium, authored]

4. The letter 'b' would appear as which letter in its water image (top-bottom flip)?

- A. b
- B. d

C. p ✓

D. q

Explanation: Flipping 'b' top-to-bottom keeps the stem on the left but moves the bowl from bottom-right to top-right — that's the letter 'p'. (Mirror and water images of the same letter generally differ — here mirror gives 'd', water gives 'p'.) [hard, authored]

5. An 'embedded figure' question primarily tests:

A. Arithmetic ability

B. Visual scanning and pattern-matching within a cluttered figure ✓

C. Vocabulary

D. Memory of a list

Explanation: Visual scanning/pattern-matching to find a hidden shape within a complex figure. [medium, web-research]

Part C – General English: Vocabulary: Spelling, Correct Usage, and One-Word Substitution

READING MATERIAL

Covers correct spelling of tricky words and one-word substitutions — replacing a descriptive phrase with a single precise word, a format TNPSC tests heavily, especially around belief-systems and power/knowledge-related words.

Q: Real exam: What is the correct spelling for "a class of people in society interested mainly in having more money and a higher social position"?

A: BOURGEOISIE — not 'Bourgeoise', 'Borgieoise', or 'Bourgeoise', confirmed by a real exam question.

Q: What is the one word for a person who knows EVERYTHING, versus a person who is ALL-POWERFUL?

A: OMNISCIENT = a person who knows everything (all-knowing). OMNIPOTENT = a person who is all-powerful — these two are commonly confused with each other since both start with 'omni'.

Q: What is the one word for a person who BELIEVES in the existence of God, versus one who DOUBTS it, versus one who DENIES it entirely?

A: THEIST = believes in the existence of God. AGNOSTIC = doubts/is uncertain about the existence of God (neither affirms nor denies). ATHEIST = denies/disbelieves in the existence of God entirely — a classic three-way confusable cluster.

Q: What is the one word for a person who opposes war and violence?

A: PACIFIST.

Q: What is the one word for a place where weapons are kept?

A: ARSENAL (not 'cellar', 'larder', or 'pantry' — those store food/wine, not weapons).

Q: What are the one-word substitutions for 'a person who loves mankind' and 'an annual publication with important dates/astronomical data'?

A: PHILANTHROPIST = a person who loves mankind (typically shown through charitable giving). ALMANAC = an annual calendar/publication containing important dates and statistical/astronomical data.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Identify the correct spelling for 'a class of people interested mainly in money and social status':

- A. Bourgeoise
- B. Borgieoise
- C. Bourgeoisie ✓**
- D. Bourgeoise

Explanation: Bourgeoisie. [medium, question-bank-2025]

2. What do you call a person who knows everything?

- A. Omnipotent
- B. Omniscient ✓**
- C. Omnipresent
- D. Scholar

Explanation: Omniscient. [medium, web-research]

3. What is the one word for a person who is all-powerful?

- A. Omniscient
- B. Almighty
- C. Omnipotent ✓**
- D. Intellectual

Explanation: Omnipotent. [medium, web-research]

4. What is the one word for a person who believes in the existence of God?

- A. Atheist
- B. Agnostic
- C. Pessimist

D. Theist ✓

Explanation: Theist. [medium, web-research]

5. What is the one word for a person who doubts the existence of God (neither affirms nor denies)?

A. Pessimist

B. Agnostic ✓

C. Realist

D. Optimist

Explanation: Agnostic. [medium, web-research]

6. Choose the correct one word for a person who opposes war and violence:

A. Activist

B. Pacifist ✓

C. Terrorist

D. Pessimist

Explanation: Pacifist. [easy, web-research]

7. What is the one word for a place where weapons are kept?

A. Arsenal ✓

B. Cellar

C. Larder

D. Pantry

Explanation: Arsenal. [medium, web-research]

8. What is the one word for a person who loves mankind?

A. Philosopher

B. Philanthropist ✓

C. Patriot

D. Pacifist

Explanation: Philanthropist. [medium, web-research]

9. What is the one word for an annual publication containing important dates and astronomical/statistical data?

A. Almanac ✓

B. Anthology

C. Periodical

D. Gazette

Explanation: Almanac. [hard, web-research]